Aerial and Space Photography

H 1210.5

A. Background 1
B. Recent revisions 2
C. Definitions 2
D. Aerial photography 2
D.1. General rule 2
D.2. By subject 2
E. Aerial photographs 2
E.1. General 2
E.2. By subject 3
E.3. By place 3
F. Aerial photographs 3
G. Photographs from space 4
Revision history 4

A. Background

The heading ***Aerial photography*** is assigned to technical works on methods of taking photographs from conventional aircraft. Headings of the type ***Aerial photography in [topic]*** are assigned to works that discuss methods of taking aerial photographs and using them to carry out work or research in a particular field. The heading ***Aerial photographs*** is assigned to general works on the handling, maintenance, cataloging, etc., of collections of aerial photographs. The subdivision ***--Aerial photographs*** is used under topical headings and under names of countries, cities, etc., for discussions or collections of aerial photographs, or reproductions of them, of a subject or place. The form subdivision ***--Aerial views*** is used for maps depicting areas observed from the air. The form subdivision ***--Photographs from space*** is used under topical headings and under names of countries, cities, etc., for collections of photographs, or reproductions of them, taken from outer space. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning these headings and subdivisions.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Aerial photographs***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Aerial photographs: Photographs taken from the air.

D. Aerial photography

D.1. General rule

Assign the heading ***Aerial photography*** to technical works on methods of taking photographs from conventional aircraft.

D.2. By subject

Assign headings of the type ***Aerial photography in [topic]*** to works that discuss methods of taking aerial photographs and using them as a tool in carrying out work or research in a particular field.

Example:

```
Title: Color aerial photography in the plant sciences and related
fields.
   650 #0 $a Aerial photography in agriculture.
   650 #0 $a Aerial photography in forestry.
   650 #0 $a Aerial photography in botany.
   650 #0 $a Color photography.
```

E. Aerial photographs

E.1. General

Assign the heading ***Aerial photographs*** to general works on the handling, maintenance, cataloging, etc., of collections of aerial photographs.

E.2. By subject

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Aerial photographs*** under topical headings to collections or discussions of aerial photographs on these topics.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading for the topic for collections of aerial photographs or reproductions of the photographs on the topic. Add the free-floating topical subdivision for discussions of aerial photographs of the topic. Do not use the form subdivision. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Aerial photographs***.

E.3. By place

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Aerial photographs*** under names of countries, cities, etc., to discussions or collections of aerial photographs, including reproductions, of these places.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading for the place for collections of aerial photographs or reproductions of the photographs of the place. Add the free-floating topical subdivision for discussions of aerial photographs of the place. Do not use the form subdivision. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Aerial photographs***.

Example:

Title: Above Baton Rouge : a pilot's view then and now.

```
651 #0 $a Baton Rouge (La.) $v Aerial photographs.
651 #0 $a Baton Rouge (La.) $x History $v Sources.
650 #0 $a Repeat photography.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Baton Rouge (La.) $x History.
650 #0 $a Repeat photography.
655 #7 $a Aerial photographs $2 lcgft
```

F. Aerial photographs

Assign the free-floating form subdivision ***--Aerial views*** under names of countries, cities, etc., or under individual educational institutions, to maps or atlases depicting those places observed from the air. Do not further subdivide by ***--Maps***.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading for the place for collections of aerial photography of the named place. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Photomaps***.

G. Photographs from space

Assign the free-floating form subdivision ***--Photographs from space*** under topical headings and under names of countries, cities, etc., for collections of photographs, or reproductions of them, taken from outer space. Use the heading ***Space photography*** for technical works on the methods of taking photographs from outer space.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading for the place for collections of photographs from space or reproductions of the photographs of the named place. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Photographs***.

Revision history

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.